

SOC/L1 - 3.4. Elastic Stack and Alert Triage With Elastic

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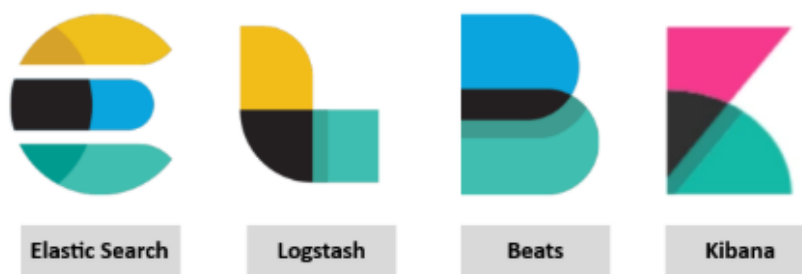
1 - Introduction

The Elastic Stack (ELK) can be used for log analysis and investigations.

Although ELK is not a traditional SIEM, many SOC teams use it like one because of its data searching and visualizing capability.

2 - Elastic Stack Overview

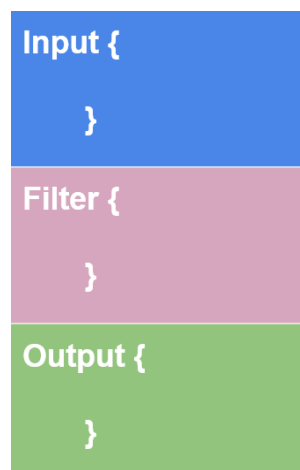
Elastic Stack (ELK) was originally developed to store, search, and visualize large amounts of data. Organizations used it to monitor application performance and perform searches on large datasets. Over time, its features made it popular in security operations as well. Now, many SOC teams use ELK almost as a SIEM solution. Elastic Stack is a collection of different open-source components that work together to collect data from any source, store and search it, and visualize it in real time.



1. Elasticsearch: The first component, Elasticsearch, is a full-text search and analytics engine for JSON-formatted documents. It stores, analyzes, and correlates data and supports a RESTful API for interacting with it.

2. Logstash: Logstash is a data processing engine that takes data from different sources, filters it, or normalizes it, and then sends it to the destination, which could be Kibana or a listening port. A Logstash configuration file is divided into three parts, as shown below.

1. The **Input** part is where the user defines the source from which the data is being ingested.
2. The **Filter** part is where the user specifies the filter options to normalize the log ingested above.
3. The **Output** part is where the user wants the filtered data to be sent. It can be a listening port, Kibana Interface, Elasticsearch database, or file.
4. Logstash supports many Input, Output, and Filter plugins.



3. Beats: Beats are host-based agents known as data-shippers that ship/transfer data from the endpoints to Elasticsearch. Each beat is a single-purpose agent that sends specific data to Elasticsearch. All available beats are shown below.

The Beats family

All kinds of shippers for all kinds of data.



Filebeat

Lightweight shipper for logs and other data



Metricbeat

Lightweight shipper for metric data



Packetbeat

Lightweight shipper for network data



Winlogbeat

Lightweight shipper for Windows event logs



Auditbeat

Lightweight shipper for audit data



Heartbeat

Lightweight shipper for uptime monitoring



Functionbeat

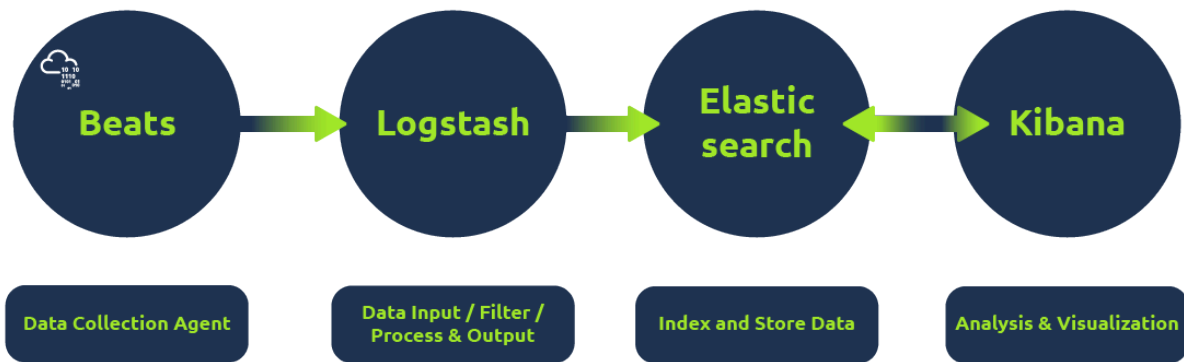
Serverless shipper for cloud data



4. Kibana: Kibana is a web-based data visualization tool that works with Elasticsearch to analyze, investigate, and visualize data streams in real time. It allows users to create multiple visualizations and dashboards for better visibility. There is more on Kibana in the following tasks.

How they work together:

- **Beats** collect data from multiple agents. For example, Winlogbeat collects Windows event logs, and Packetbeat collects network traffic flows.
- **Logstash** collects data from beats, ports, or files, parses/normalizes it into field value pairs, and stores them into Elasticsearch.
- **Elasticsearch** acts as a database used to search and analyze data.
- **Kibana** is responsible for displaying and visualizing the data stored in Elasticsearch. The data stored in Elasticsearch can easily be shaped into different visualizations, time charts, infographics, etc., using Kibana.



Logstash is used to visualize the data. nay

Elasticstash supports all data formats apart from JSON. nay

3 - Discover Tab

The Discover tab is where the SOC analysts spend most of their time. This tab shows the ingested logs, the search bar, normalized fields, and more. Analysts can search for the logs, investigate anomalies, and apply filters based on search terms and time periods.

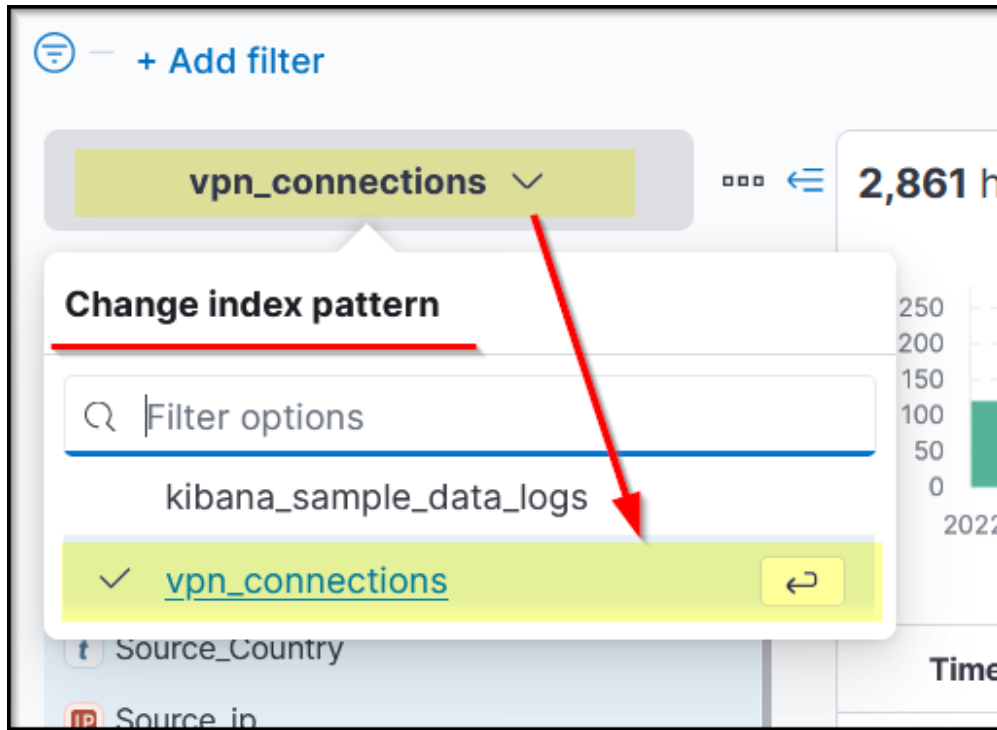


Let's briefly see what each element (as highlighted in the above screenshot) of the Discover tab does:

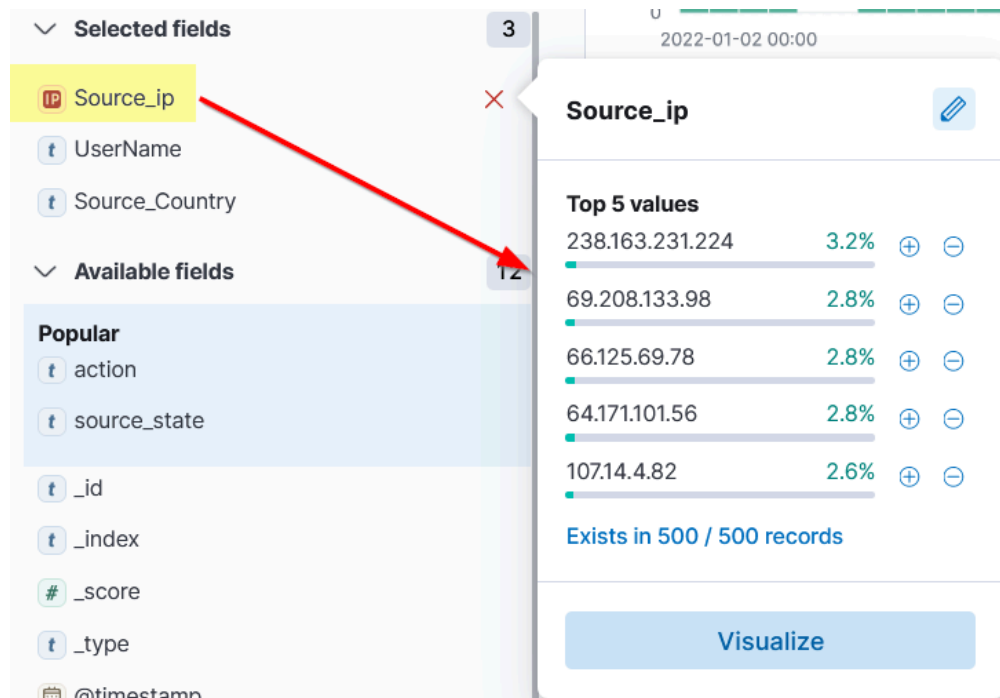
1. **Logs:** Each row shows a single log containing information about the event, along with the fields and values found in that log.
2. **Fields Pane:** The left panel of the interface shows the list of fields parsed from the logs. We can click on any field to add it to the filter or remove it from the search.
3. **Index Pattern:** Each type of log is stored in a different index pattern. We can select the index pattern from which we need the logs. For example, for VPN logs, we would need to select the index pattern in which VPN logs are stored.
4. **Search Bar:** It is a place where the user adds search queries and applies filters to narrow down the results. In the next task, we will learn how to perform searches through queries.
5. **Time Filter:** We can narrow down results based on any specific time duration.
6. **Time Interval:** This chart shows the event counts over time.
7. **TOP Bar:** This bar contains various options to save the search, open the saved searches, share or save the search, etc.
8. **Discover Tab:** This is the main workspace in Kibana for exploring, searching, and analyzing raw data.
9. **Add Filter:** We can apply filters to specific fields to narrow down results, rather than manually typing entire queries.

Some of the important elements found in the Discover tab are briefly explained below:

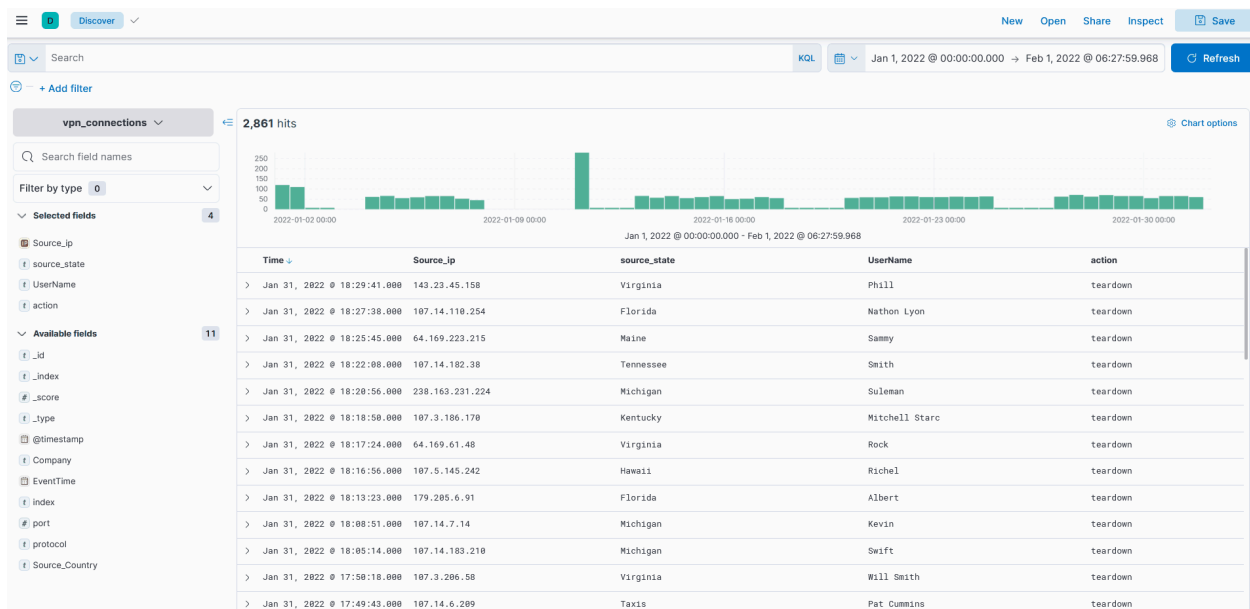
Index Pattern: By default, Kibana requires an index pattern to access the data stored/ingested in Elasticsearch. The **index pattern** tells Kibana which elasticsearch data we want to explore. Each Index pattern corresponds to certain defined properties of the fields. A single index pattern can point to multiple indices. Each log source has a different log structure; therefore, when logs are ingested into Elasticsearch, they are first normalized into corresponding fields and values by creating a dedicated index pattern for the data source. In the attached lab, we will explore the index pattern `vpn_connections` which contains the VPN logs.



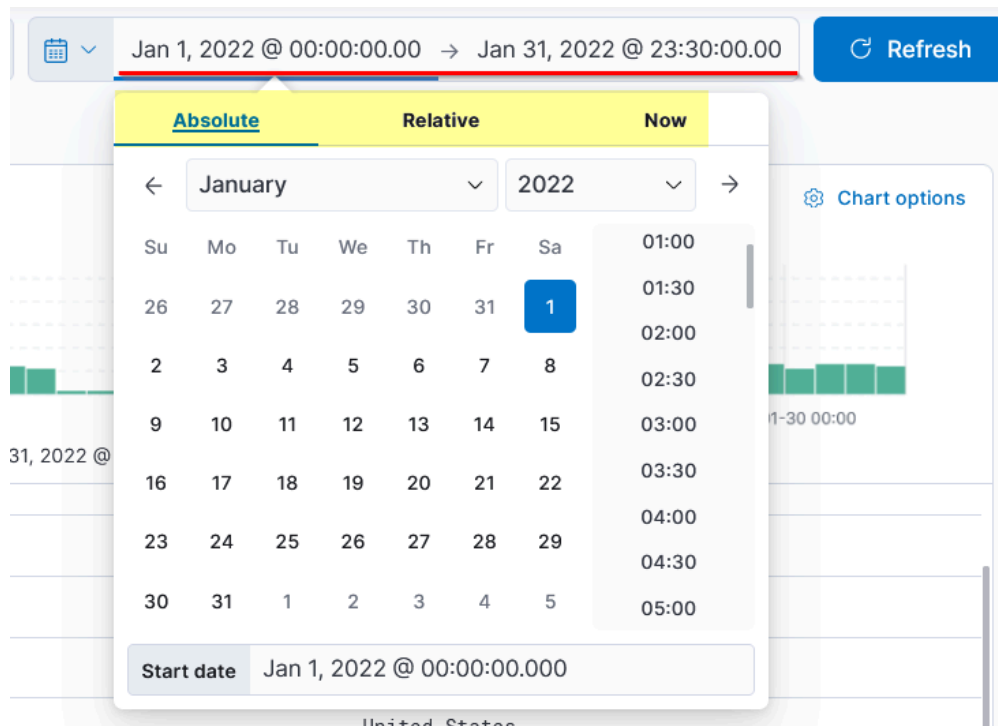
Fields Pane: The left panel in the Discover tab shows the list of the normalized fields it finds in the available logs. Click on any field, and it will show the top 5 values and the percentage of occurrence. We can use these values to apply filters to them. Clicking on the  button will add a filter to show the logs containing this value, and the  button will add a filter to show the results that do not have this value.



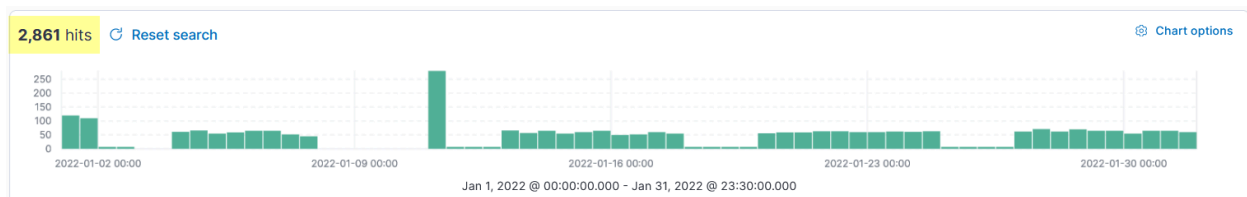
We can also apply filters to any of the fields shown in the panel on the left. All we have to do is click the **Add filter** option under the search bar, which will allow us to apply a filter to the fields shown below.



Time Filter: The time filter allows us to apply a log filter based on time. It has many options.

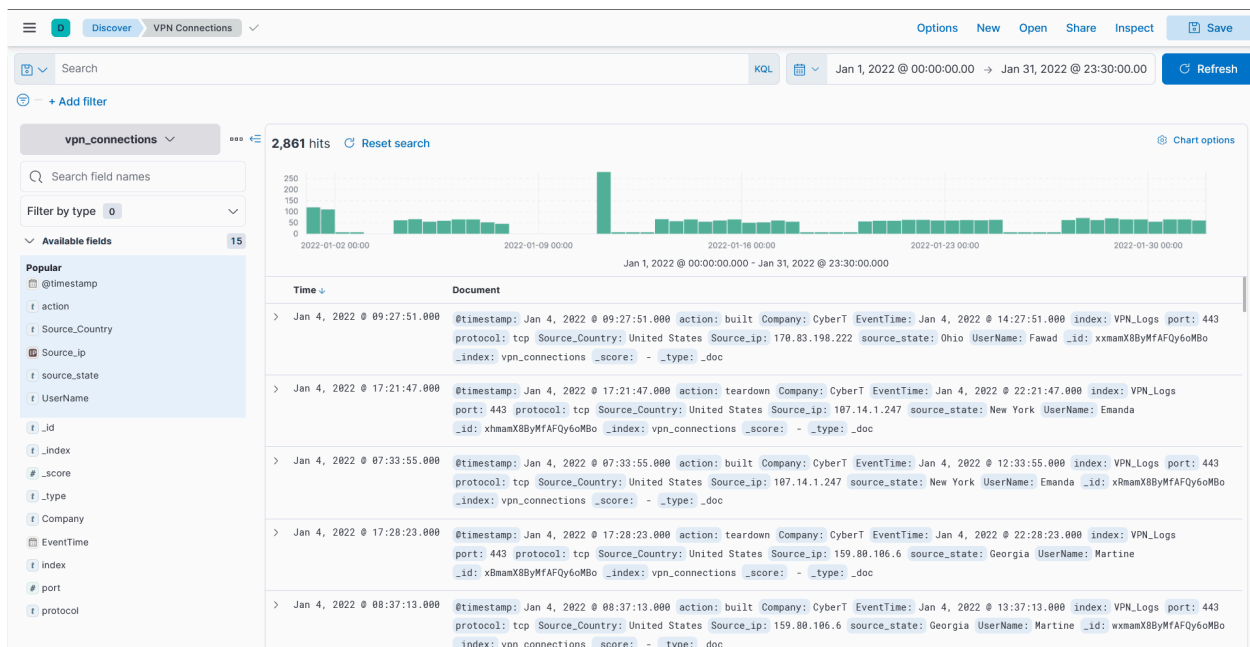


Timeline: The timeline pane provides an overview of the number of events that occurred for the time/date, as shown below. We can only select the bar to show the logs in that period. The count at the top left displays the number of events found in the specified time.



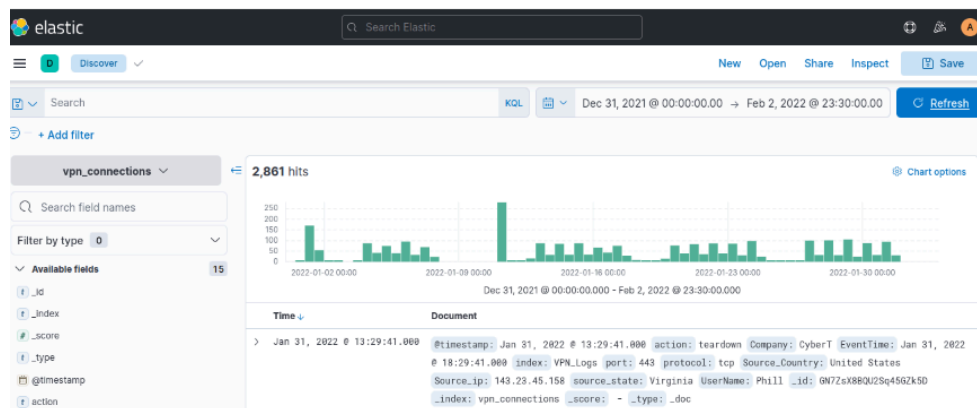
This bar is also helpful in identifying the spike in the logs. In the above screenshot, we can see an unusual log spike on 11th January 2022.

Create Table: By default, the logs are shown in raw form. We can click on any log and select important fields to create a table showing only those fields. This method reduces the noise and makes it more presentable and meaningful.

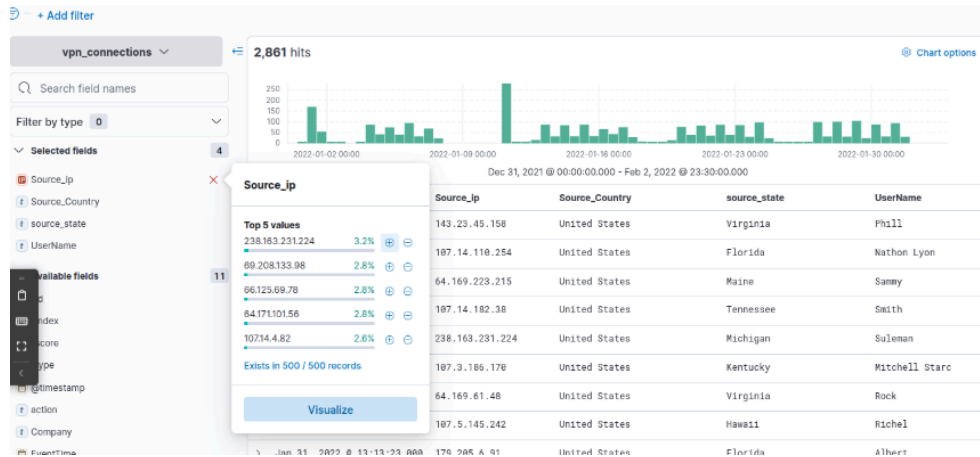


You can also save the table format once it is created. It will then show the same fields every time a user logs into the dashboard

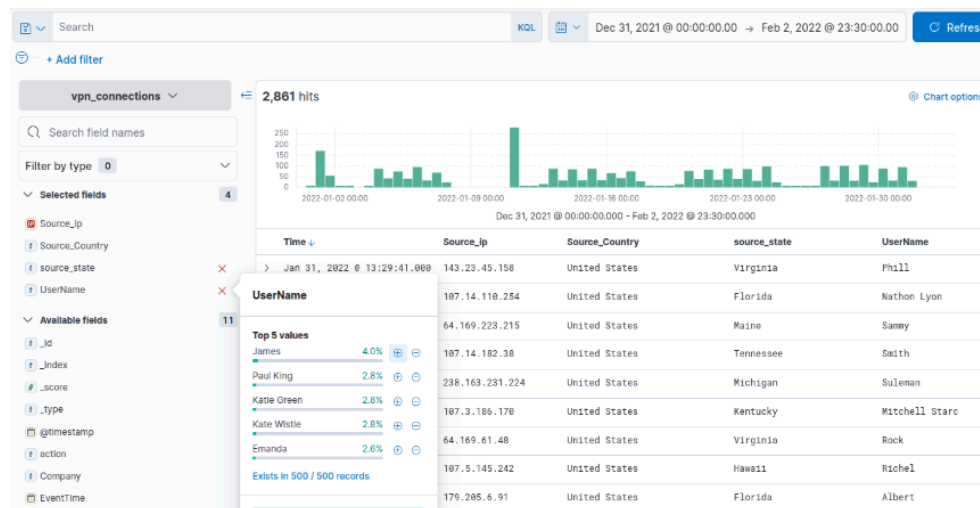
Select the index `vpn_connections` and filter from 31st December 2021 to 2nd Feb 2022. How many hits are returned? 2861



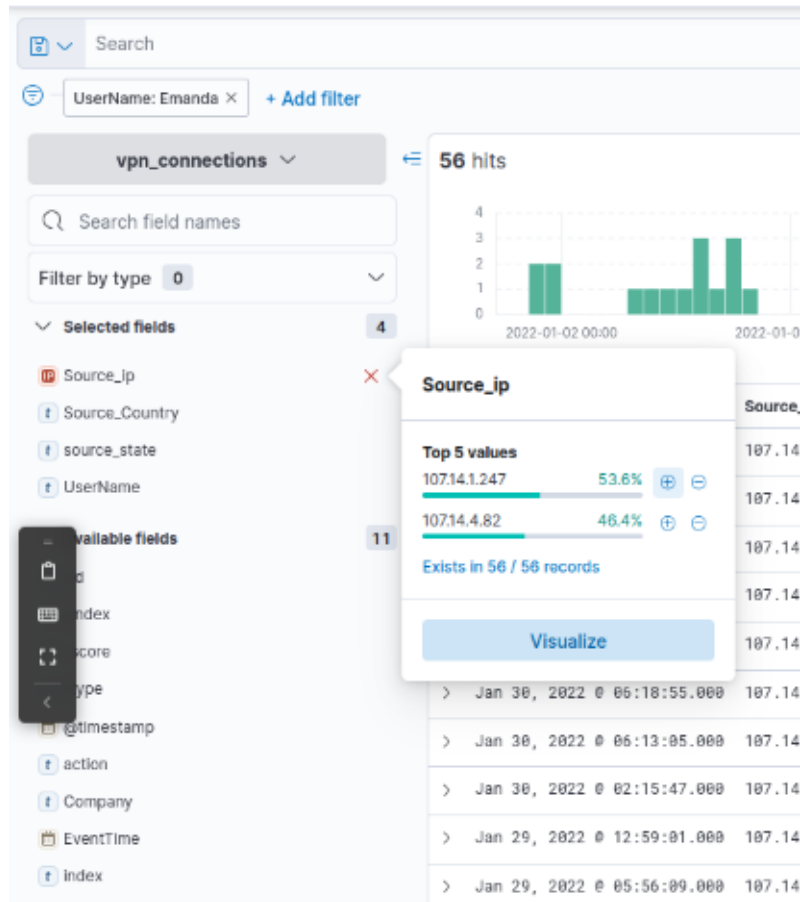
Which IP address has the maximum number of connections? 238.163.231.224



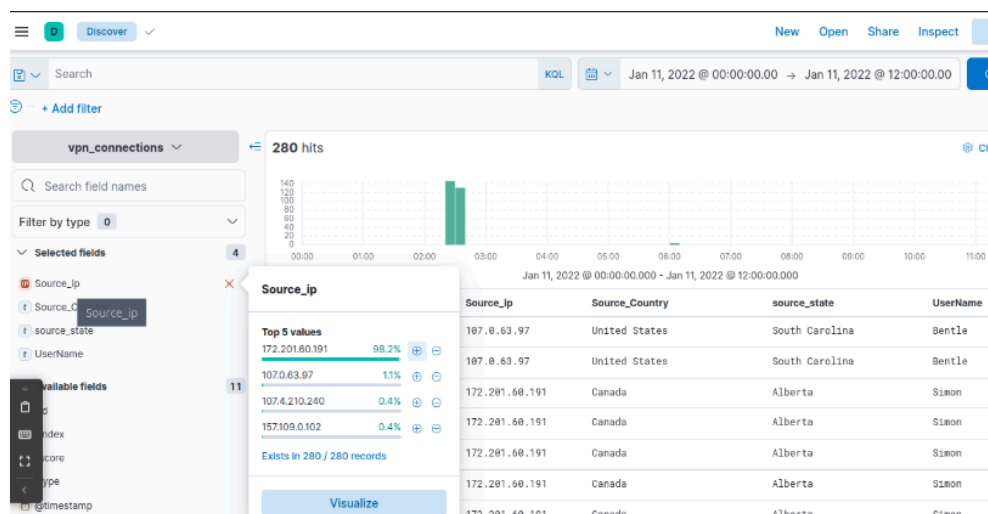
Which user is responsible for the overall maximum traffic? James



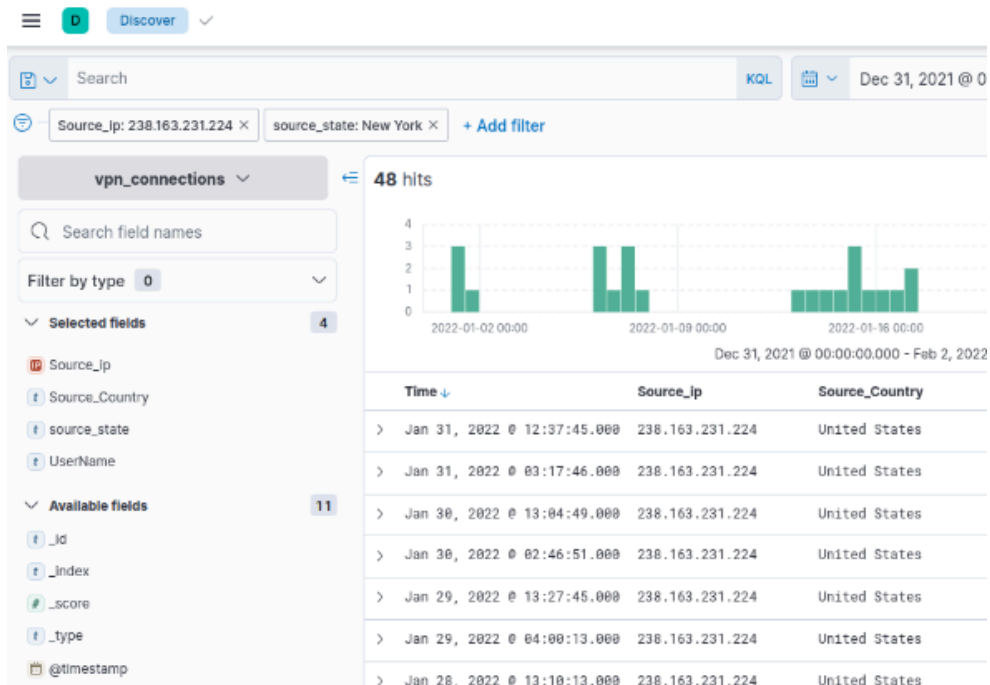
Apply Filter on UserName Emanda; which SourceIP has max hits? 107.14.1.247



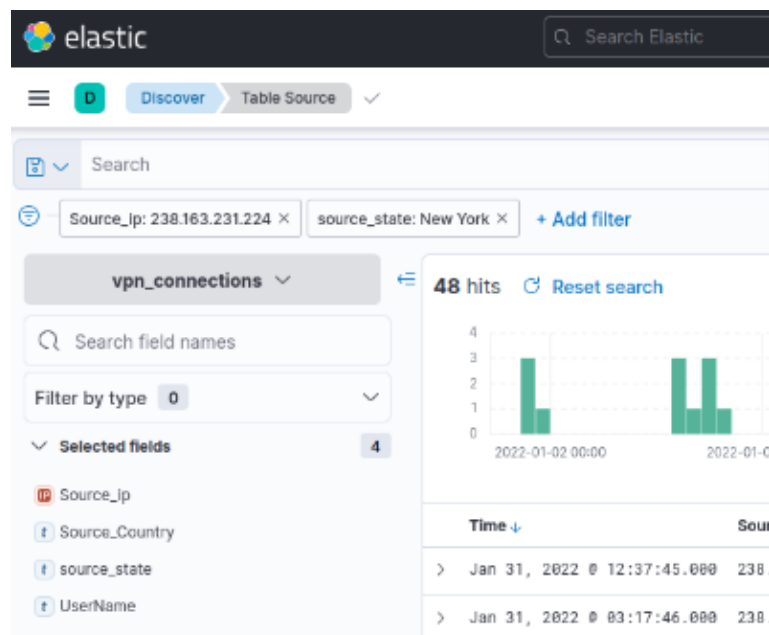
On 11th Jan, which IP caused the spike observed in the time chart?
172.201.60.191



How many connections were observed from IP 238.163.231.224, excluding the New York state? 48

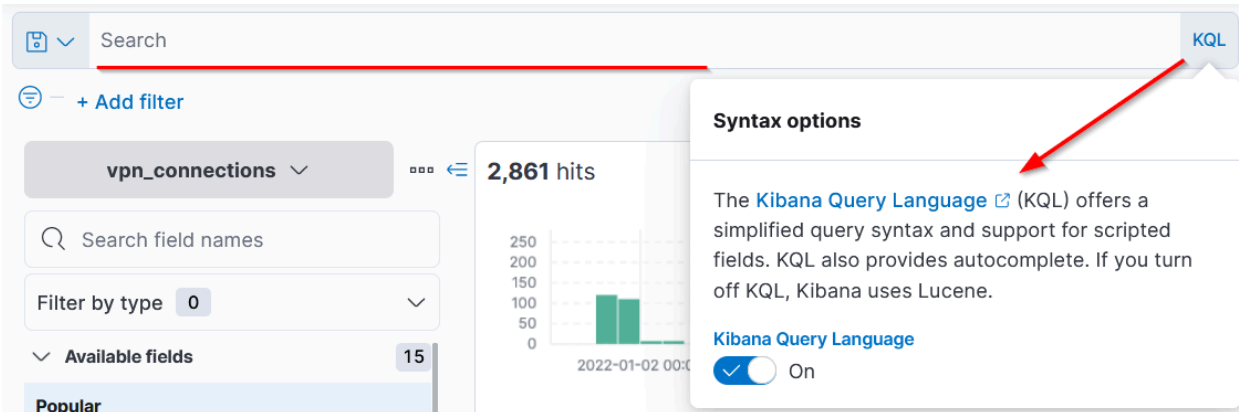


Create a table with the fields IP, UserName, Source_Country and save.

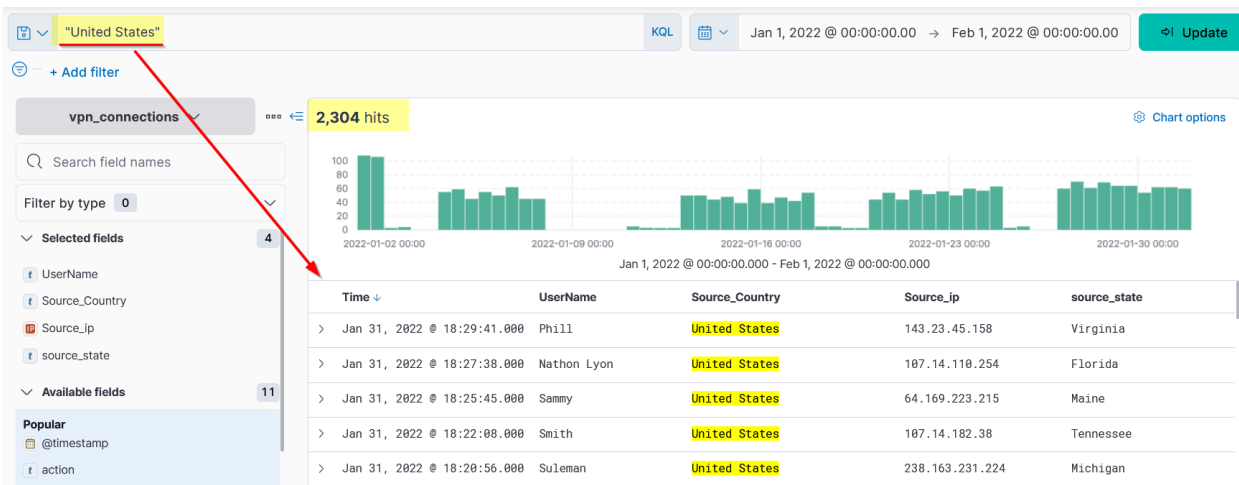


4 - KQL Overview

There is a special language that we can use inside this search bar to perform our searches. KQL (**Kibana Query Language**) is a search query language used to search the ingested logs/documents in Elasticsearch.



Free text Search: Free text search allows users to search for logs based on text only. That means a simple search of the term `security` will return all the documents that contain this term, irrespective of the field. Let's search for the text `United States` in the search bar. It will return all the logs that contain this term, regardless of the place or the field. This search returned 2304 hits, as shown below.



What if we only search for the term `United` ? Do you think it will return any results?

The screenshot shows the Kibana search interface. The search bar contains the query "United". Below the search bar, there are filters for "vpn_connections" and a list of selected fields: "UserName", "Source_Country", "Source_ip", and "source_state". The search results section displays a message: "No results match your search criteria". To the right of this message is an illustration of a magnifying glass with a red exclamation mark. Below the message, there are two suggestions: "Expand your time range" (Try searching over a longer period of time.) and "Adjust your query" (Try searching for a different combination of terms.).

It didn't return any results because KQL looks for the whole term/word in the documents. KQL allows the wildcard `*` to match parts of the word. Let's find out how to use this wild card in the search query.

Search Query: `United*`

The screenshot shows the Kibana search interface with the search query "United*". The search results section displays a message: "2,304 hits". Below this message is a bar chart showing the distribution of results over time. Below the chart is a table with the following columns: "Time", "UserName", "Source_Country", "Source_ip", and "source_state". The table contains four rows of results, all with "United States" in the "Source_Country" column. A red arrow points from the search bar to the "Source_Country" column in the table.

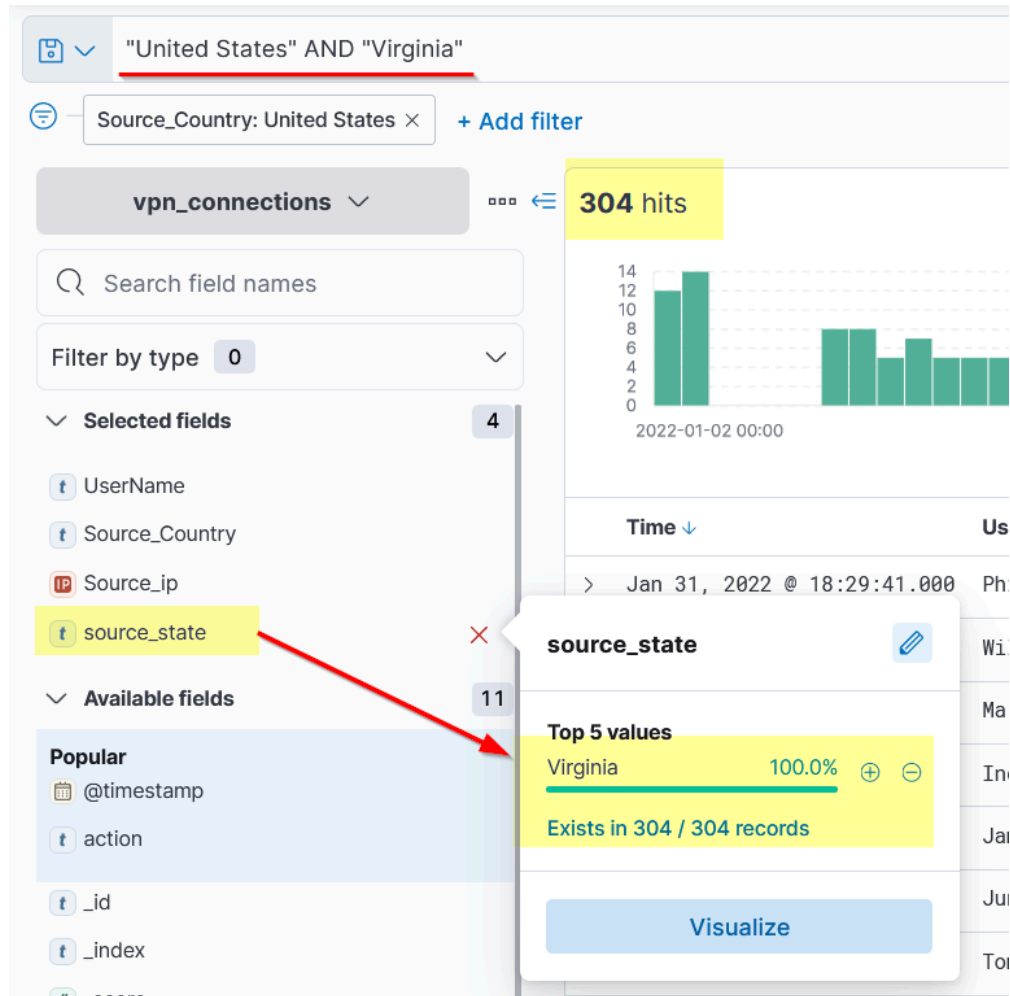
Time	UserName	Source_Country	Source_ip	source_state
> Jan 31, 2022 @ 18:29:41.000	Phill	United States	143.23.45.158	Virginia
> Jan 31, 2022 @ 18:27:38.000	Nathon Lyon	United States	107.14.110.254	Florida
> Jan 31, 2022 @ 18:25:45.000	Sammy	United States	64.169.223.215	Maine
> Jan 31, 2022 @ 18:22:08.000	Smith	United States	107.14.182.38	Tennessee

We have used the wildcard with the term `United` to return all the results containing the term United and any other term after it. If we had logs with the term `United Nations`. It would also have returned those as a result of this wildcard.

Logical Operators (AND | OR | NOT)

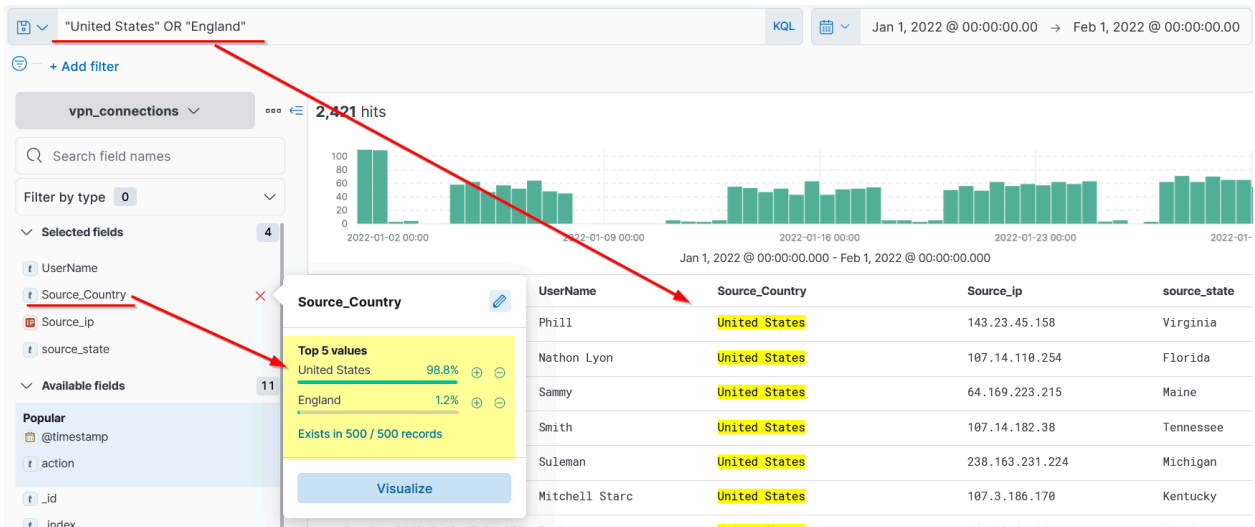
1. AND Operator: Here, we will use the **AND** Operator to create a search that returns the logs containing the terms `"United States"` and `"Virginia"`.

Search Query: `"United States" AND "Virginia"`



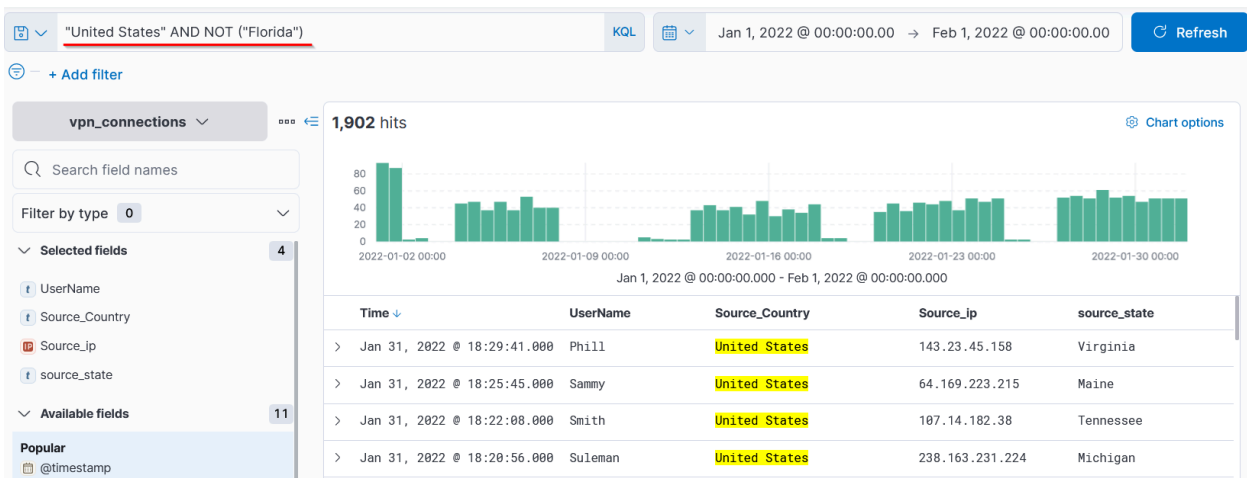
2. OR Operator: We will use the **OR** operator to show logs that contain either the `United States` or `England`.

Search Query: `"United States" OR "England"`



3. NOT Operator: Similarly, we can use the **NOT** Operator to remove a particular term from the search results. This search query will show the logs from **the United States**, including all states, but ignoring Florida.

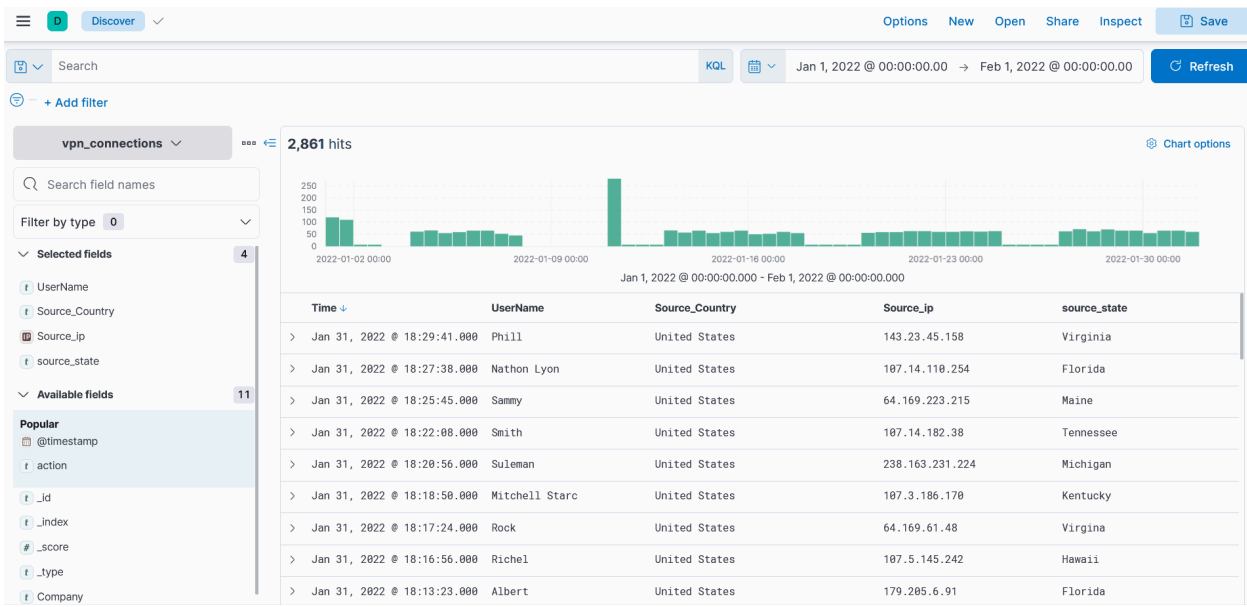
Search Query: `"United States" AND NOT ("Florida")`



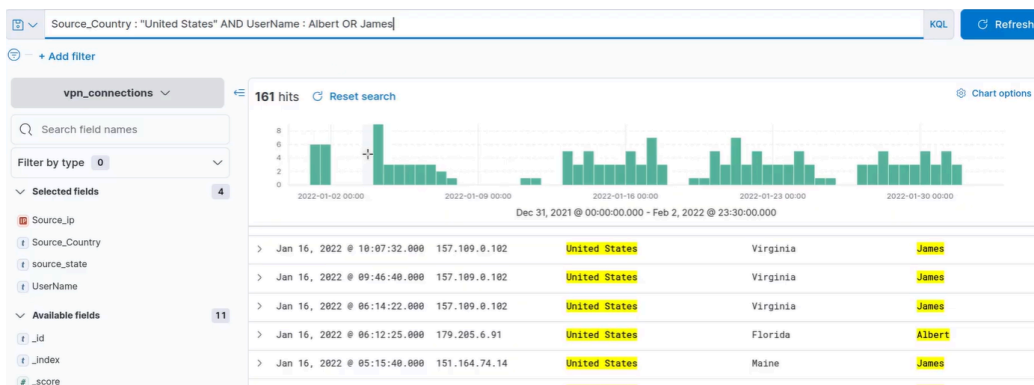
In the Field-based search, we will provide the field name and the value we are looking for in the logs. This search has a special syntax as `Field: Value`. It uses a colon as a separator between the field and the value. Let's look at a few examples.

Search Query: `Source_ip : 238.163.231.224 AND UserName : Suleman`

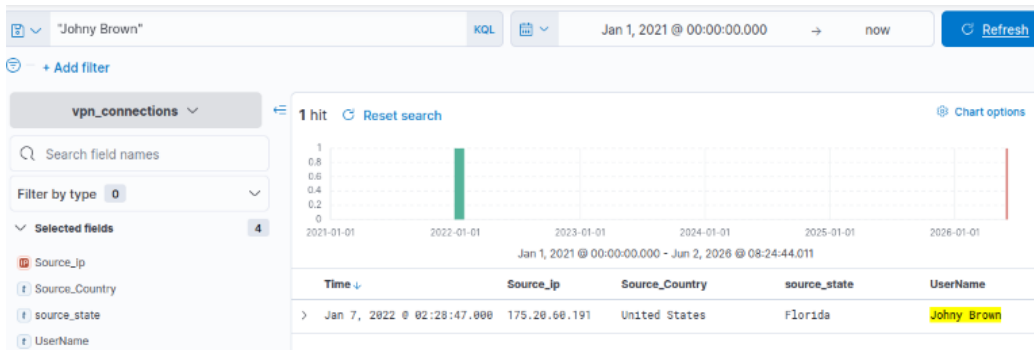
Explanation: We are telling Kibana to display all the logs in which the field `Source_ip` contains the value `238.163.231.224` and `UserName` is `Suleman`, as shown below.



Create a search query to filter the logs where Source_Country is the United States and show logs from User James or Albert. How many records were returned? 161



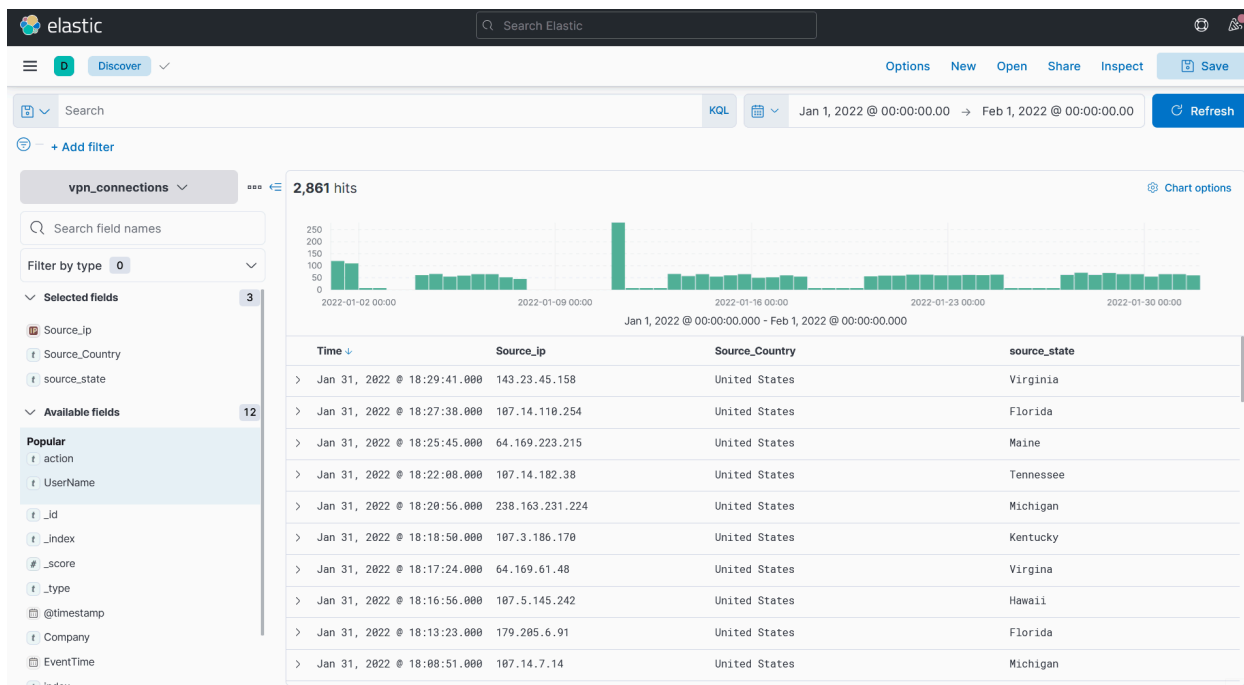
A user Johny Brown was terminated on the 1st of January, 2022. Create a search query to determine how many times a VPN connection was observed after his termination. 1



5 - Creating Visualizations

The visualization tab allows us to visualize the data in different forms such as tables, pie charts, bar charts, etc. This visualization task will use the multiple options this tab provides to create some simple presentable visualizations.

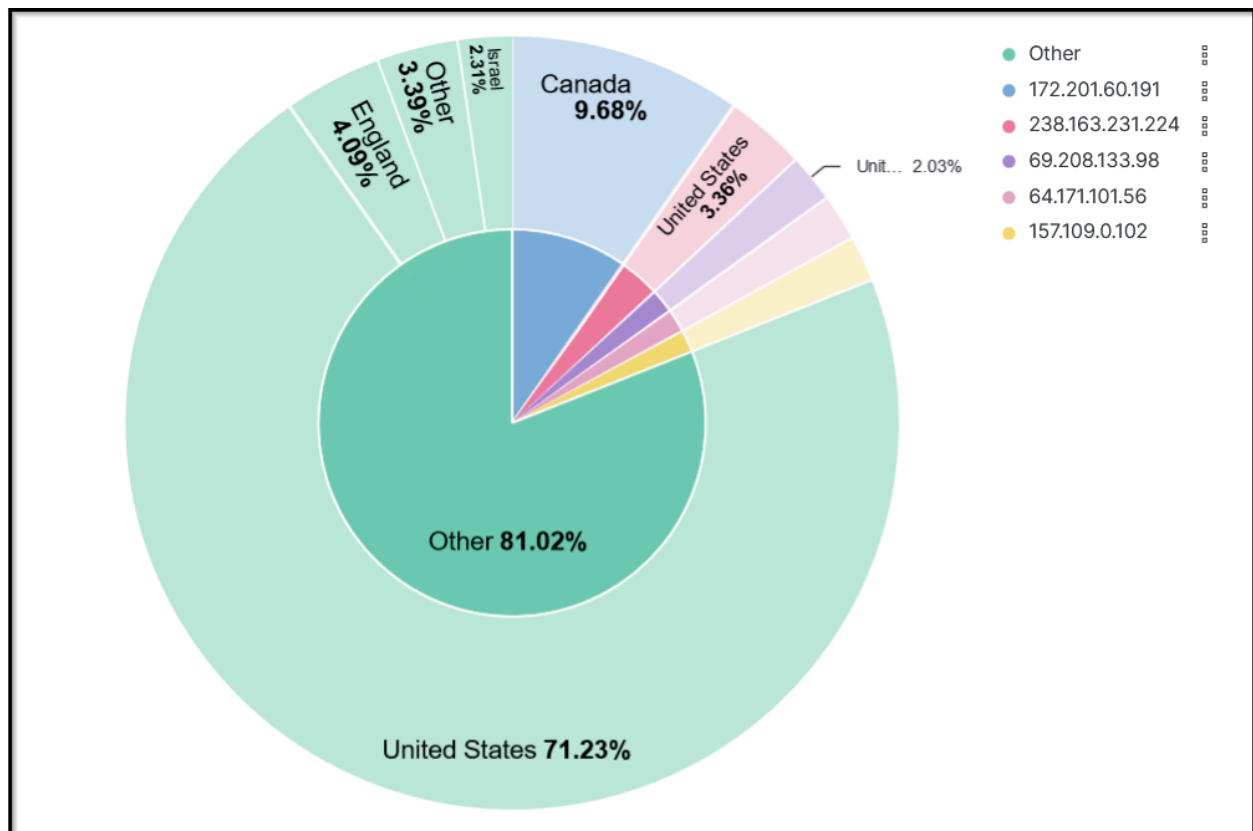
There are a few ways to navigate to the visualization tab. One way is to click on any field in the discover tab and click on the visualization as shown below.



We can create multiple visualizations by selecting options like tables, pie charts, etc.

Correlation Option: Often, we require creating correlations between multiple fields. Dragging the required field in the middle will create a correlation tab in the

visualization tab. Here, we selected the `Source_Country` as the second field to show a correlation among the client `Source_IP`.



We can also create a table to show the values of the selected fields as columns, as shown below.

Table ▾		
Top values of Source_ip ▾	Top values of Source_Country ▾	Count of records ▾
172.201.60.191	Canada	277
238.163.231.224	United States	96
69.208.133.98	United States	58
64.171.101.56	United States	56
157.109.0.102	United States	56
159.80.106.6	United States	56
179.205.6.91	United States	53
136.242.218.208	United States	52
143.23.45.158	United States	52
81.243.196.221	United States	50
107.3.69.92	United States	50
109.0.146.197	United States	50

The most important step in creating these visualizations is saving them. To do so, click on the save Option on the right side and fill in the descriptive values below.

Save Lens visualization

Title

TOP IP VS TOP Country

Add to dashboard

Existing

Search dashboards...

New

None

Add to library

Description

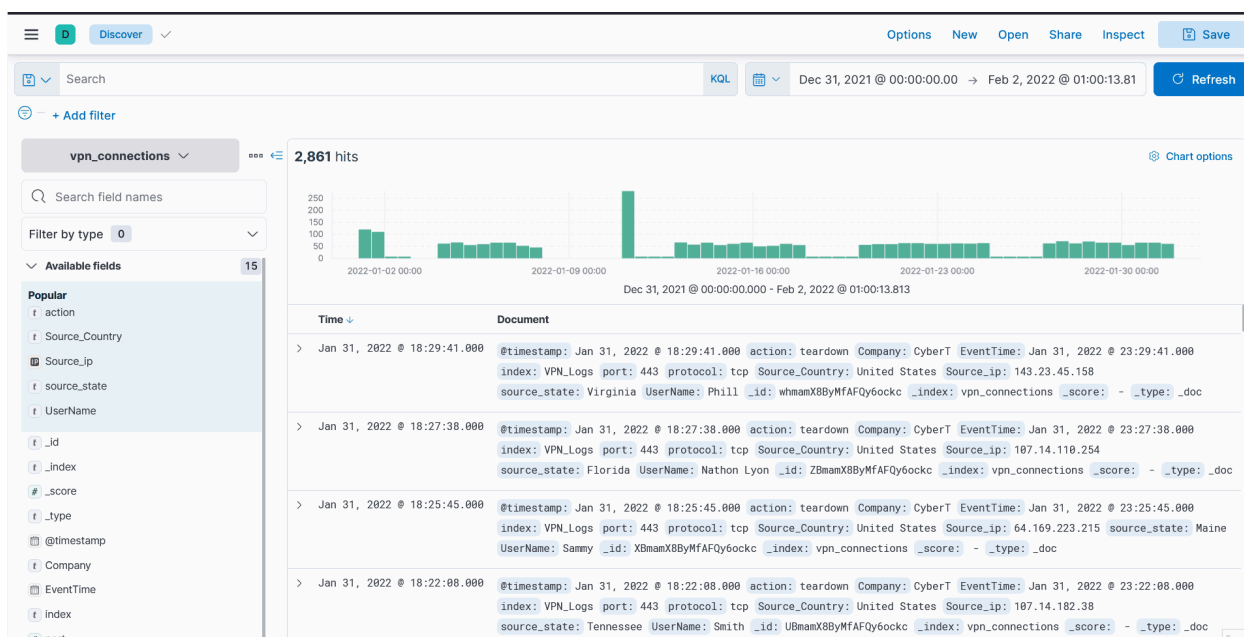
TOP IP VS TOP Country

Tags

Cancel

Save and add to library

Failed Connection Attempts Visualization: We'll use the knowledge gained above to create a table to show the user and the IP address involved in failed attempts.



Which user was observed with the greatest number of failed attempts? Simon

The screenshot shows the Kibana search interface. At the top, there's a search bar with 'vpn_connections' and a filter 'action: failed'. The date range is set to 'Dec 31, 2021 @ 00:00:00.00' to 'Feb 2, 2022 @ 23:30:00.00'. The results are displayed in a table view. The table has three columns: 'Top values of UserName', 'Top values of Source_ip', and 'Count of records'. The first row shows 'Simon' as the user, '172.201.60.191' as the source IP, and '274' as the count of records.

Top values of UserName	Top values of Source_ip	Count of records
Simon	172.201.60.191	274

How many wrong VPN connection attempts were observed in January? 274

6 - Creating Dashboards

Dashboards provide good visibility into log collection. A user can create multiple dashboards to fulfill a specific need. In this task, we can combine different saved searches and visualizations to create a custom dashboard for VPN log visibility.

Creating a Custom Dashboard: By now, we have saved a few **Searches** from the **Discover tab**, created some **Visualizations**, and saved them. It's time to explore the dashboard tab and create a custom dashboard. The steps to create a dashboard are:

- Go to the **Dashboard tab** and click on the **Create dashboard**.



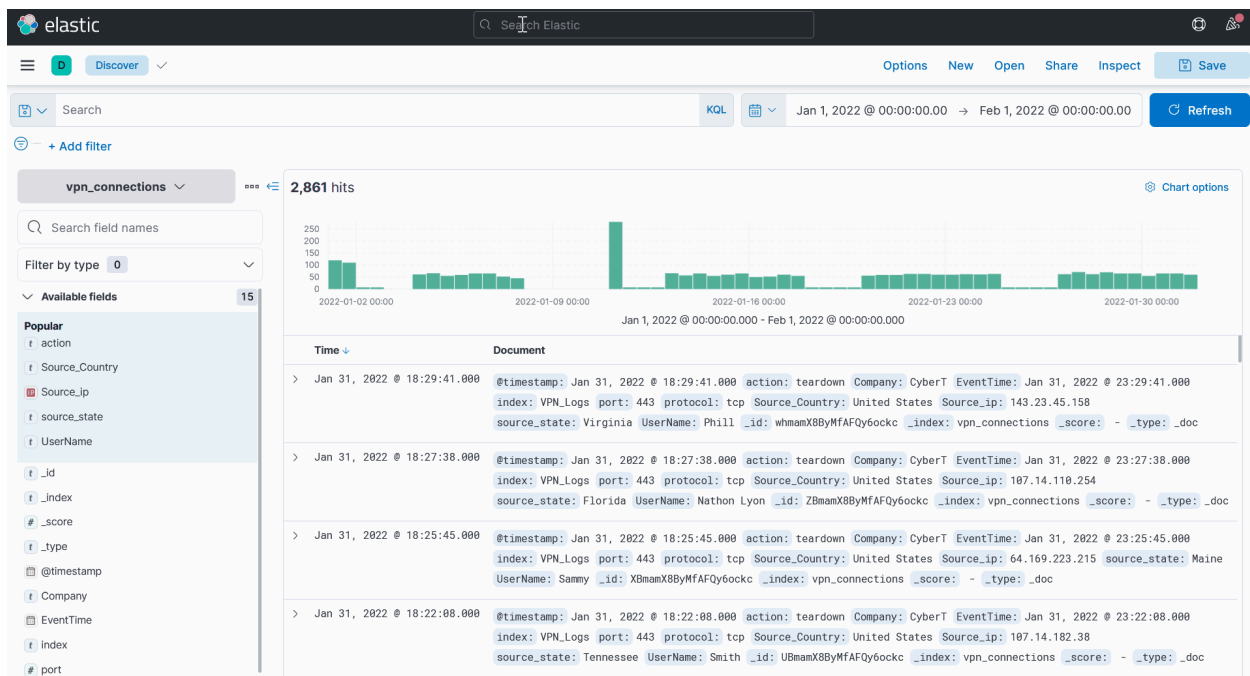
Create your first dashboard

You can combine data views from any Kibana app into one dashboard and see everything in one place.

New to Kibana? [Install some sample data](#) to take a test drive.

 Create new dashboard

- Click on `Add from Library.`
- Click on the visualizations and saved searches. It will be added to the dashboard.
- Once the items are added, adjust them accordingly, as shown below.
- Don't forget to save the dashboard after completing it.

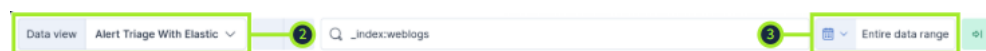


7 - Alert Triage With Elastic Introduction

As a Security Operations Center (SOC) analyst, you aim to investigate alerts and escalate incidents with clear evidence to support your findings. In this guided-challenge room, you'll use Kibana (part of the Elastic Stack) to perform alert triage and initial investigations, analyzing suspicious activity on an IIS and Windows server. You'll explore potential indicators of compromise (IoCs) and collect evidence by correlating events across multiple log sources to gain a deeper understanding of the attack.

8 - Scenario Briefing

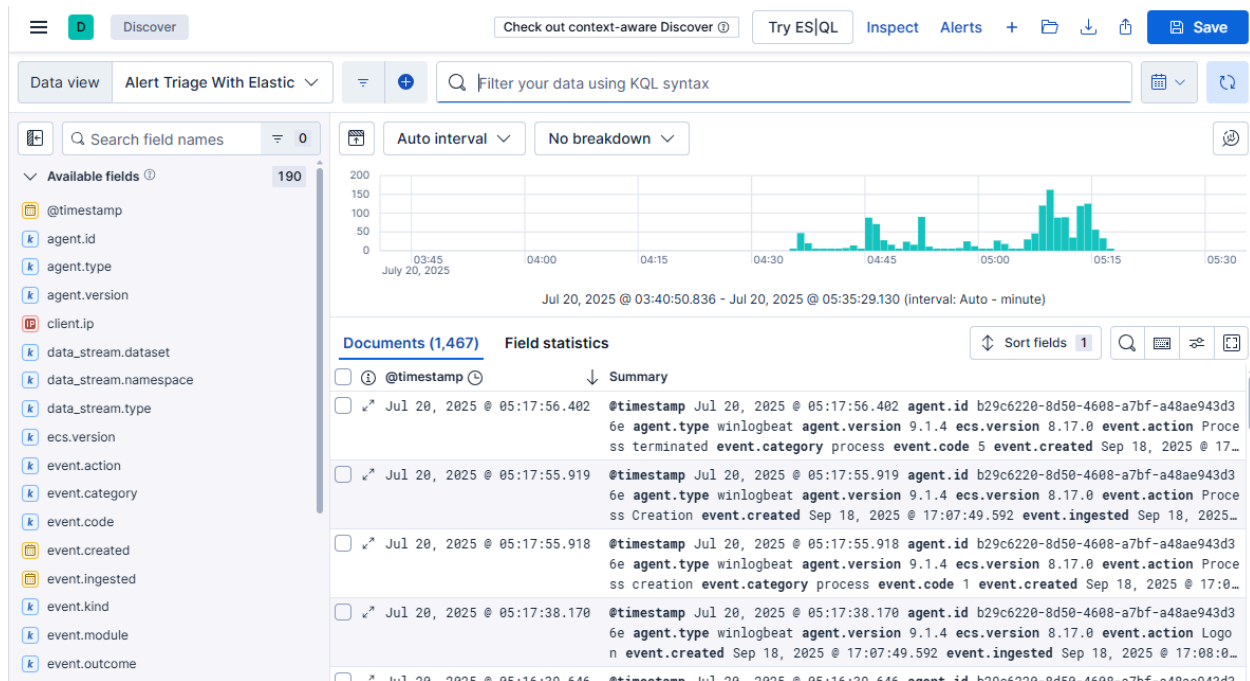
1. Access Kibana
2. Select the Data view: You need to choose Alert Triage With Elastic for this room
3. Select the time range: For now, select Entire data range to view all ingested logs



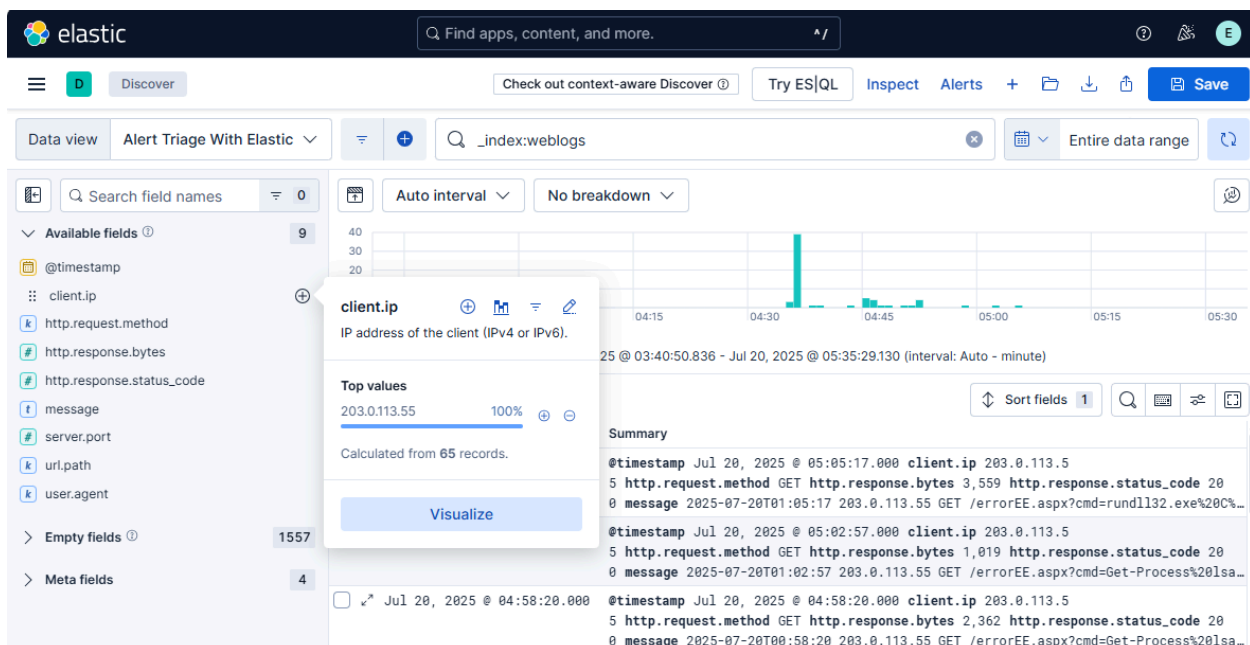
The Data view selected includes two indices. For the second question, please enter your first query **`_index:weblogs`** to filter for only IIS web server logs, which

we will begin with in the next task. Before moving on, take a moment to check out the available fields on the left side of the dashboard.

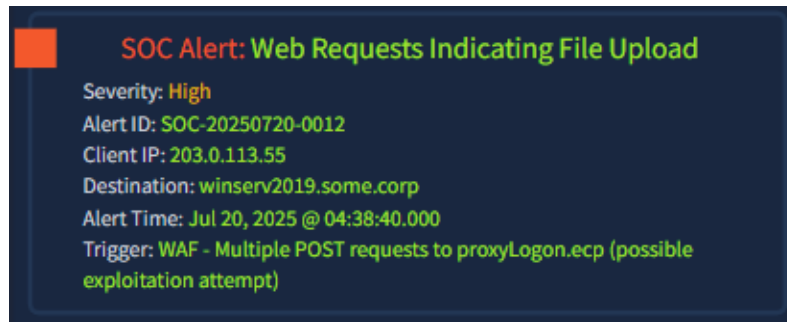
How many logs are available for analysis within the entire time range? 1467



What is the field value for the client.ip in the weblogs index? 203.0.113.55



9 - Investigating SOC Alert: Web Requests Indicating File Upload

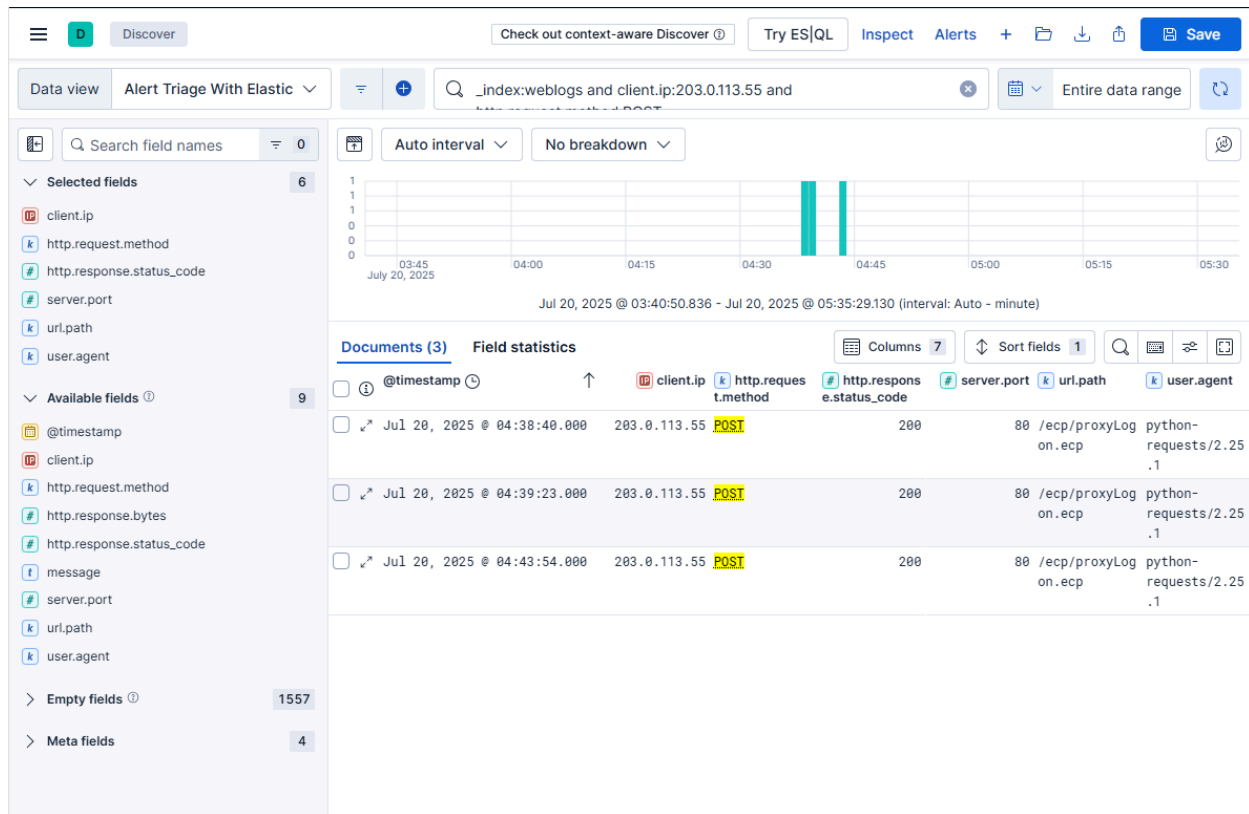


Now that we have set up the Kibana interface, we can begin to investigate the alerts. Let's take a moment to consider the information we have. The alert above shows the IP address `203.0.113.55` made `POST` requests to the page `proxyLogon.ecp`. Even if you don't know how the page can be exploited, your first goal is to visualize all web requests from the IP address. Let's build out a table using the information below and answer the first two questions about the requests.

1. Append your current query to include the IP address and highlight `POST` requests `_index:weblogs and client.ip:203.0.113.55 and http.request.method:POST`
2. Start building your table by hitting the `+` next to any field on the left side to add it as a columnAdd `client.ip`, `user.agent`, `http.request.method`, `url.path`, and `http.response.status_code`

Highlighting the above fields will help you view the log data in a more structured and legible manner, making it easier to identify indicators. You can use the query and table to answer the first two questions.

Selected Fields:

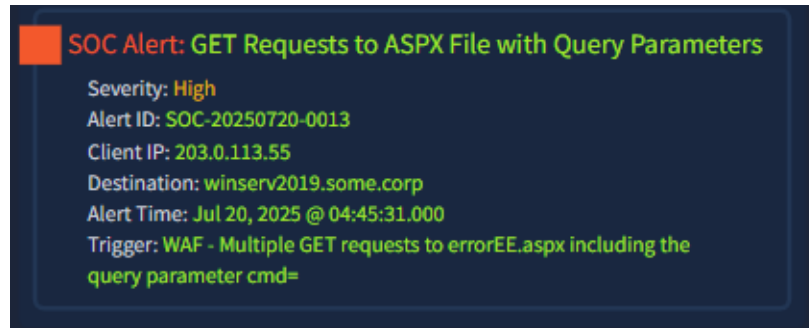


How many POST requests did the IP address 203.0.113.55 make to proxyLogon.ecp? 3

Which user.agent paired with the IP address 203.0.113.55 made the POST requests? python-requests/2.25.1

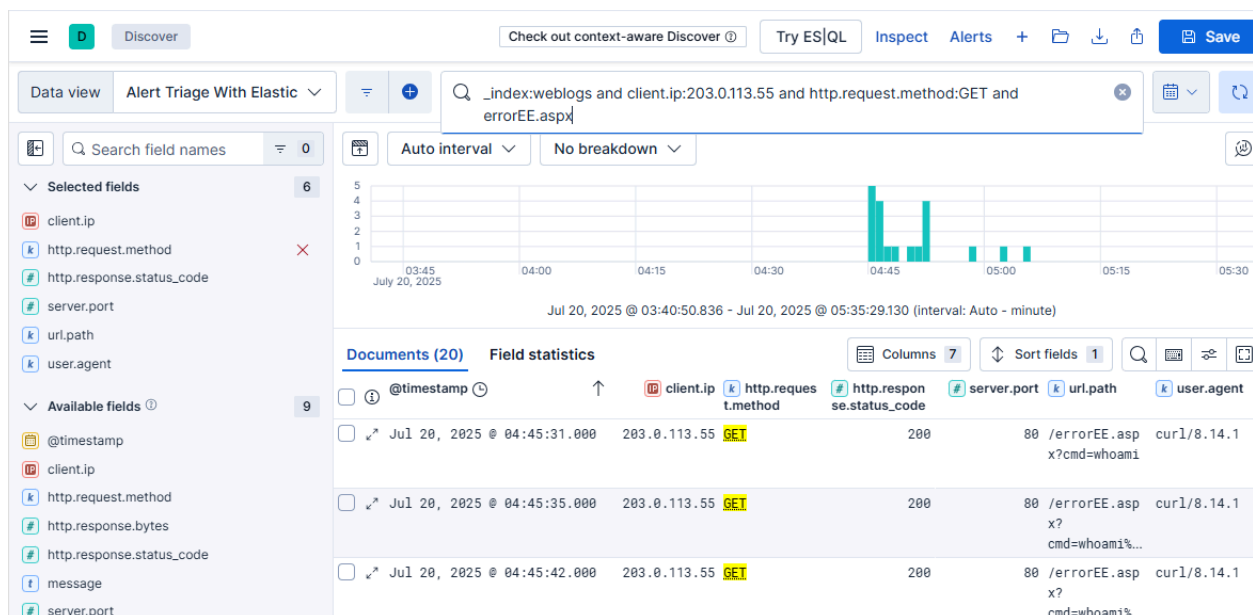
10. Investigating SOC Alert: GET Requests to ASPX File with Query Parameters

How many logs contain the cmd= query parameter in the url.path field? 20



The alert concerns the same client IP address and comes just seven minutes after the first one. We will use the alert details to investigate whether this is indeed a True Positive. Look at the Trigger field; the `cmd=` parameter is a hallmark of web shell activity, as attackers can append commands directly to it. For example, `cmd=id` where `id` is the command being executed. Let's see whether we can confirm a web shell:

1. Alter your query to search for `GET` requests and the file name `errorEE.aspx_index:weblogs` and `client.ip:203.0.113.55` and `http.request.method:GET` and `errorEE.aspx`
2. Sort `Old-New` to see the requests that came in first at the top

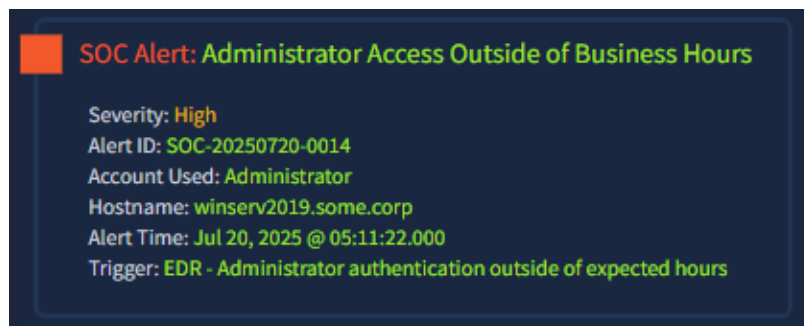


We can add also in command line: `_index:weblogs` and `url.path:*cmd=*`

Which command was run utilizing errorEE.aspx on Jul 20, 2025 @ 04:45:50.000? hostname

Documents (20)		Field statistics		Columns 7		Sort fields 1		   	
☐  @timestamp 		 client.ip	 http.request.method	 http.response.status_code	 server.port	 url.path	 user.agent		
☐  Jul 20, 2025 @ 04:45:31.000		203.0.113.55	GET	200	80	/errorEE.aspx?cmd=whoami	curl/8.14.1		
☐  Jul 20, 2025 @ 04:45:35.000		203.0.113.55	GET	200	80	/errorEE.aspx?cmd=whoami%...	curl/8.14.1		
☐  Jul 20, 2025 @ 04:45:42.000		203.0.113.55	GET	200	80	/errorEE.aspx?	curl/8.14.1		
☐  Jul 20, 2025 @ 04:45:50.000		203.0.113.55	GET	200	80	/errorEE.aspx?cmd=hostname	curl/8.14.1		

11. Investigating SOC Alert: Administrator Access Outside of Business Hours



Your web log investigation raised red flags, but suspicious network traffic is only part of the story. You need to pivot to host-based evidence to determine if the attacker has moved further. The alert shows that the **Administrator** account accessed the server outside of business hours. Your first step is to confirm the logon. When, how, and from where did it occur? Investigate Windows Security Event ID **4624** (Logon) to gather the context. Let's begin by focusing on events that occurred on or after the specified time in the alert. We will focus on Security Event ID **4624** (Logon), our client's hostname, and the **Administrator** user. `@timestamp >= "2025-07-20T05:11:22" and winlog.event_id:4624 and host.name:winserv2019.some.corp and winlog.event_data.TargetUserName:Administrator`

Again, we will add fields as columns to construct a table, allowing relevant information to be easily highlighted.

1. `winlog.event_id`: Windows Event ID

2. `host.name` : Target hostname on which the logon occurred
3. `winlog.event_data.TargetUserName` : User account that logged in
4. `winlog.logon.type` : How the user accessed the system (e.g., remotely via RDP)
5. `winlog.event_data.IpAddress` : The source IP address of the client, a very important field

What is the winlog.record_id of the Administrator 4624 logon event? 17166

The screenshot shows the Elastic Stack interface with the following details:

- Search Bar:** `@timestamp >=`
- Filters:** `winlog.event_id: 4624` and `winlog.event_data.TargetUserName: Administrator`
- Visualizations:** A timeline chart showing a single event at 05:11:22.545 on Jul 20, 2025.
- Documents (1):**

Field	Value
<code>@timestamp</code>	Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:11:22.545
<code>host.name</code>	winserve2019.some.corp
<code>winlog.event_data.TargetUserName</code>	Administrator
<code>winlog.event_id</code>	4624
- Document Panel:** Shows the `winlog.record_id` as 17166.

What is the process.pid of the Sysmon 1 event that occurred on Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:11:27.996? 964 (sysmon 1 = winlog.event_id:1)

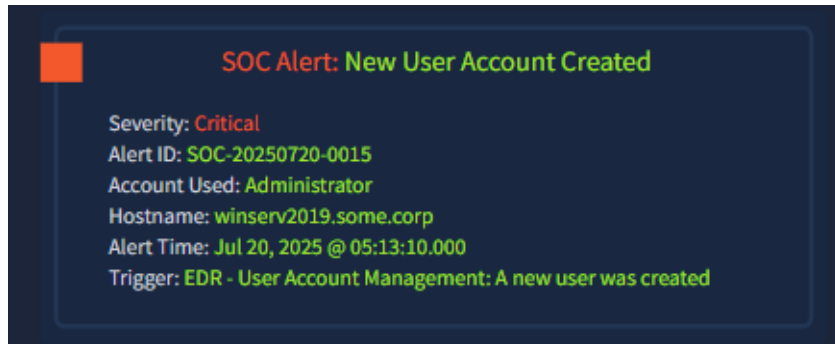
The screenshot shows the Elastic Stack interface with the following details:

- Search Bar:** `@timestamp:"2025-"`
- Filters:** `winlog.event_data`
- Visualizations:** A timeline chart showing a single event at 05:11:27.996 on Jul 20, 2025.
- Documents (1):**

Field	Value
<code>@timestamp</code>	Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:11:27.996
<code>winlog.event_id</code>	1
<code>agent.id</code>	b29c6228-8d58-4688-a7bf-a48ae943d36e
<code>agent.type</code>	winlogbeat
<code>agent.version</code>	9.1.4
<code>ecs.version</code>	8.0.0
- Document Panel:** Shows the `process.pid` as 964.

11. Investigating SOC Alert: New User Account Created

What is the winlog.event_id for the new user account being created? 4720

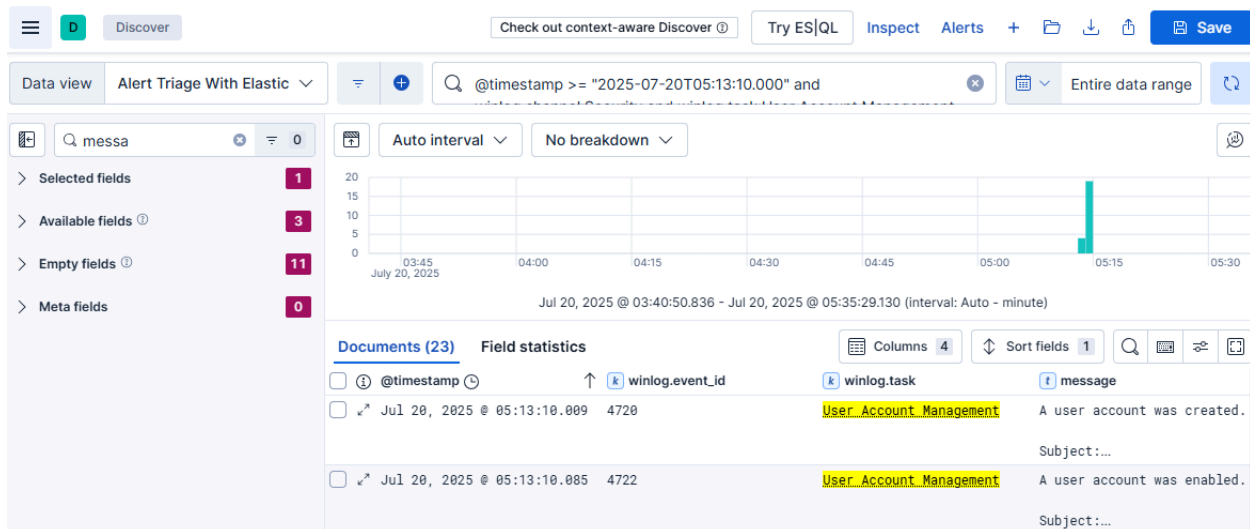


To begin investigating this alert, we can use similar queries that we have already employed. Here is a query to begin your investigation.

```
@timestamp >= "2025-07-20T05:13:10.000" and winlog.channel:Security and winlog.task:User Account Management
```

In the above query, we are focusing on Windows Security logs and the `winlog.task` field. This field gives a human-readable context about what type of activity the event represents. Try creating a table with these three fields after submitting the query and answering the remaining task questions. Don't forget to sort `Old-New` to see the events that occurred first, at the top.

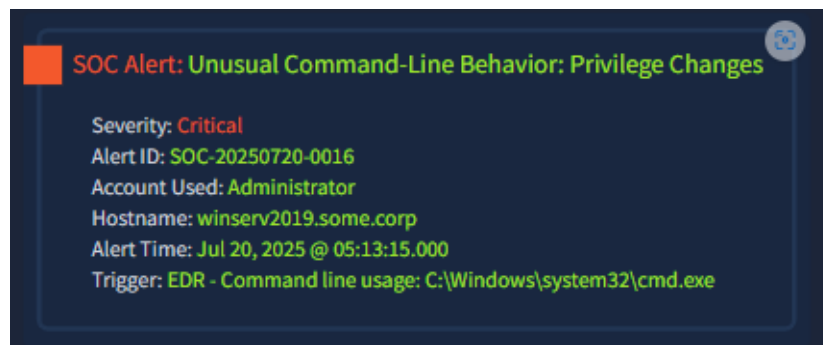
1. `winlog.event_id`
2. `winlog.task`
3. `message`



What is the name of the new user account? `svc_backup`

Documents (36)		Field statistics		Columns 7		Sort fields 1		  	
  @timestamp 	  host.name	 process.parent.name	 process.parent.com mand_line	 process.name	 process.command_li ne	 user.name			
 Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:12:52.444	winserv2019.some.co rp	svchost.exe	C:\Windows\system32\svchost.exe -k ...	svchost.exe	C:\Windows\system32\svchost.exe /...	Administrator			
 Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:12:59.714	winserv2019.some.co rp	explorer.exe	"C:\Windows\Explorer.EXE" /NOUACHECK	cmd.exe	"C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe"	Administrator			
 Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:13:00.061	winserv2019.some.co rp	cmd.exe	"C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe"	conhost.exe	"C:\Windows\system32\conhost.exe"	Administrator			
 Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:13:09.417	winserv2019.some.co rp	cmd.exe	"C:\Windows\system32\cmd.exe"	net.exe	net user svc_backup Passw0rd123! /add /domain				

12. Investigating SOC Alert: Unusual Command Line Behaviour: Privilege Changes



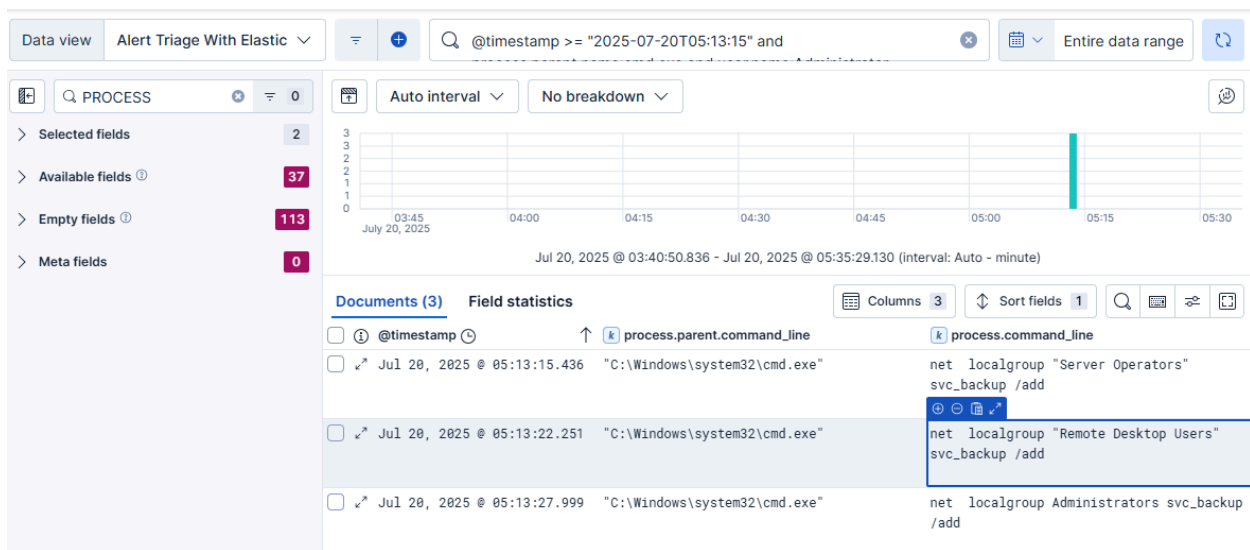
This next alert flags suspicious command-line usage from the same Administrator account. Could the attacker be escalating their actions? Let's investigate. As a Level 1 SOC analyst, your first steps should be:

1. **Scope the alert:** Identify the child processes launched by `cmd.exe`
2. **Confirm the origin:** Find out who launched `cmd.exe` and why
3. **Check for privilege changes:** Look for commands like `net` used to add users to groups
4. **Correlate across log sources:** Use Sysmon and Windows Security logs to confirm the malicious behavior

Crafting a query to highlight Sysmon events that occurred on or after the stated time and include the parent process `cmd.exe` will help you clearly see what commands were executed. `@timestamp >= "2025-07-20T05:13:15" and process.parent.name:cmd.exe and user.name:Administrator` Let's make a simple table to

investigate the commands executed by dding `process.command_line`, `process.name`, and `process.parent.name` as columns.

What command does the attacker use to add the new account to the "Remote Desktop Users" group? `net localgroup "Remote Desktop Users" svc_backup /add`

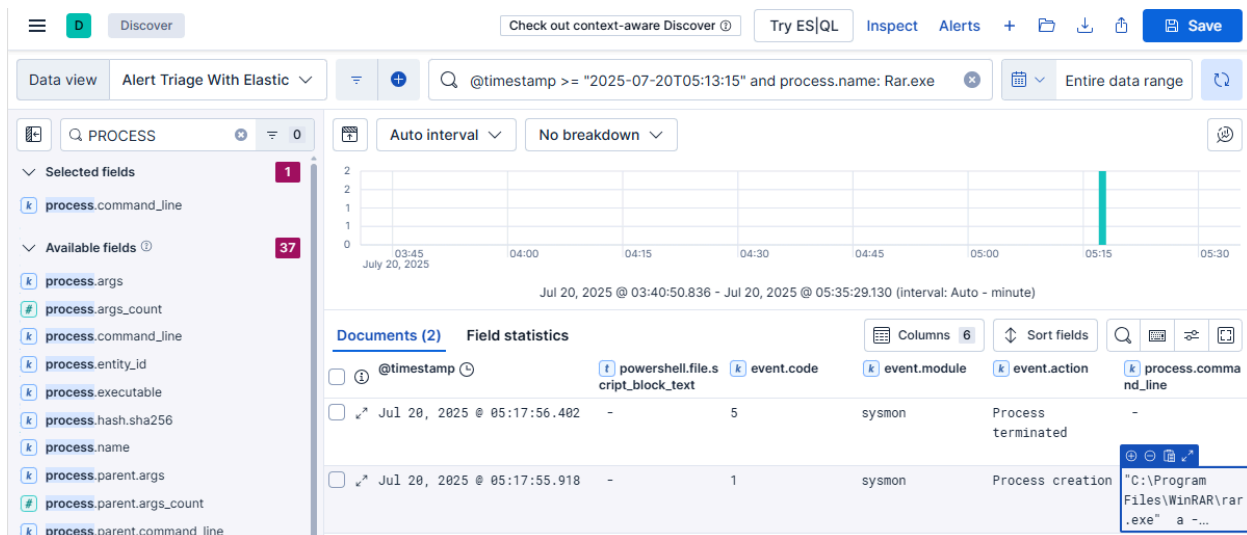


What is the winlog.record_id of the 4732 Security event when the attacker adds the user to the Administrator group? 17254

What PowerShell command did the attacker run on Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:16:14.628? `net group "Domain Admins" /domain`

Documents (15) Field statistics				
☐ @timestamp	☐ powershell.file_script_block_text	☐ event.code	☐ event.module	☐ event.action
☐ Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:16:22.986	<code>dir /s /b C:*.xml</code>	4104	powershell	Execute a Remote Command
☐ Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:16:14.818	<code>prompt</code>	4104	powershell	Execute a Remote Command
☐ Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:16:14.628	<code>net group "Domain Admins" /domain</code>	4104	powershell	Execute a Remote Command
☐ Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:16:08.396	<code>prompt</code>	4104	powershell	Execute a Remote Command
☐ Jul 20, 2025 @ 05:16:08.242	<code>net localgroup Administrators</code>	4104	powershell	Execute a Remote Command

What is the name of the archive that the attacker creates using the Rar.exe executable? finance_it_archive.rar



No Alert Created: Not every malicious action is covered by SOC alerts, and often you need to look deeper into the logs to uncover the full attack. In your investigation, you might have noticed the compression tool **Rar.exe** being utilized by the newly created account. No alert was created because this is legitimate software used by your client. Investigate the usage of the executable using Sysmon logs to answer the final question with this query.

```
process.name: "Rar.exe"
```

Even though no alert was generated, this is your chance to seal the deal on the investigation. As a SOC analyst, your responsibility is not only to find artifacts, but also to determine what they mean in context:

- Do you have sufficient evidence to suggest that this activity is malicious, or is it benign?
- Can you correlate across log sources to show which account executed the tool, when, and how?
- Does the timing or parent process indicate potential abuse?